



▲ **The Batasia Loop** on the Darjeeling Himalayan Railway (DHR) is considered one of the most remarkable engineering feats of its time. Also called a double spiral, this gravity-defying loop was commissioned in 1919. The entire DHR track is 82 km with an open view of more than 12 peaks, including Kanchenjunga, the third highest mountain in the world.

“The royal Bengal tiger is in great force there, and is very bold and unconventional. From this lonely little station a message once went to the railway manager in Calcutta: ‘Tiger eating station-master on front porch; telegraph instructions’.”

MARK TWAIN ON THE DARJEELING HILL RAILWAY, *FOLLOWING THE EQUATOR: A JOURNEY AROUND THE WORLD* (1897)